



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

South Africa: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-04

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 106 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 106 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 51 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-04, 8 did not, 28 carry no stated baseline, and 11 are **Not held** at both ends. A further 7 took a position dated after 2026-08-04 and are carried in the status report rather than compared here.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 459 sources for this place in the window — 58 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 401 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The largest measurable delivery of the twelve months was administrative. Smart identity documents through bank branches went from 30 branches across five banks in August 2025 to [296 branches and more than 385,000 applications in four months](#) by July 2026, and the 1,000-branch target originally set for 2029 was pulled forward to 750 by end-2026.

Against that, three instruments went backwards. The draft national artificial-intelligence policy was [withdrawn in April 2026](#) after fabricated references were found in it. The ministerial policy direction of 11 December 2025 intended to unblock satellite licensing was [rejected by the regulator in May 2026](#). SA Connect phase two was [declared ended in the February 2026 Budget Review](#) rather than completed, against a 2022 cabinet target of universal access in 36 months.

Most stated delivery dates in the period moved.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Delivered data-centre load	~350MW (2024 benchmark)	~390MW (2025)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Draft Radio Frequency Spectrum and Fees Regulations amendments	Regulations of 2015 and 2010 unamended	Gazetted 2026-05-15; oral hearings 19-20 August 2026	ADVANCED
Equinix Cape Town land use	Baseline not held	Tribunal approval 2026-07-14	ADVANCED
High-demand spectrum auction	No date	No date; R51m appropriated	STALLED
IMT Roadmap 2026 and draft assignment plans	Baseline not held	Out for consultation	ADVANCED
Innovation spectrum, lower 6GHz	Draft, March 2025	Gazetted 2026-05-22	ADVANCED
LEO satellite licensing framework	Policy direction gazetted 2025-12-12	Direction rejected 2026-05	REGRESSED
National broadband map (DBSA)	None published	Launched 2026-03-31	ADVANCED
National Radio Frequency Plan 2026	Baseline not held	Gazetted 2026-07-24	ADVANCED
SA Connect phase 2	Suspended pending rollover (2025-09)	Declared ended (2026-02)	CLOSED
Satellite market entry via section 13	Baseline not held	Amazon Leo-Herotel, 2026-07-15	ADVANCED
State Digital Infrastructure Company (network merger)	Road map due FY2025/26	Implementation moved to FY2028/29	REGRESSED
National cyber-security measurement	2024 CSIR surveys	Unchanged; no re-measurement	NO CHANGE
National CSIRT (Cybersecurity Hub)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating; no incident statistics published	Baseline not held
National Cybersecurity Policy Framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force; the instrument the national CSIRT rests on	Baseline not held
National GIS infrastructure database (rapid deployment reg. 7)	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-04)	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Teraco CT2, Cape Town	Baseline not held	+32MW to 50MW, 2025-11	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
FSCA enforcement against online financial harm	107 public warnings; R119.8m penalties (FY2024/25)	140 public warnings; R2.89bn penalties on 76 persons (FY2025/26)	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Electronic Communications Amendment Bill	Baseline not held	Published; submissions to 2026-08-21	ADVANCED

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Draft National Policy on Data and Cloud	Draft	Draft; date of instrument disputed	NO CHANGE

SA Connect closed rather than delivered. Its in-year allocation [collapsed from an expected R1.1bn to R116m](#), money arrived only in January 2026 and equipment in the final month of the financial year; the Budget Review recorded 6,343 government facilities and 32,055 hotspots, with R888.8m over the medium term to maintain 948 phase-one sites. The state network merger moved the other way: the FY2025/26 deliverable was a finalised road map, and the [annual performance plan tabled in March 2026](#) starts again with a preliminary report and implementation in FY2028/29.

On satellite, an instrument was issued and neutralised within five months. Starlink launched in its [27th African country in July 2026](#) without entering South Africa, while Amazon took the acquisition route the Act already allows.

Announced data-centre capacity and delivered capacity diverged. Pipeline announcements would take national load [above 1,200MW](#); delivered live load moved from roughly 350MW to 390MW, and the only completed facility of scale in the period was [Teraco's 50MW CT2](#). No national cyber-security measurement was repeated during the twelve months.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
MzansiXchange data exchange	One-year pilot launched 2025-10-09	Nine months in; extra capacity onboarding	ADVANCED, STALLING
SAHPRA VigiFlow serious-adverse-event e-reporting pilot	Did not exist	Pilot open by invitation; no duration or mandatory date published	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Digital driving licence	Promised for 2026	Nearest dated milestone 2027-03	STALLED
Draft Identification Regulations amendments	Did not exist	Gazetted 2026-05-04; consultation closed	ADVANCED
Electronic travel authorisation	Pilot from 2025-10	203,000 processed, 5,700+ rejected (2026-07-21); national launch 2026-08-12	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National digital identity (credential and wallet)	"Before the 2029 elections" (2025-12)	Hosting 2027-03-31; credentials 2027/28	STALLED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
CIPS participation (Standard Bank)	No African bank held CIPS direct-participant status	Standard Bank live as the first African bank offering CIPS transactions; RMB the settlement currency	ADVANCED
Renminbi Clearing Bank of Africa	Did not exist; CIPS participation only (live 2025-11-20)	Standard Bank and ICBC jointly authorised as RMB clearing bank for Africa, with operational capacity in the 19 African countries where Standard Bank Group operates	ADVANCED
Payments Ecosystem Modernisation credential and wallet	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-07-31)	Baseline not held
Retail central bank digital currency	BASELINE NOT HELD	Planned, not proceeding (2026-06)	Baseline not held

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Blocked identity numbers	384,189 (2025-12)	377,060	STALLED
Intelligent Population Register	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-06)	Baseline not held
National Population Register	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2026-06-08)	Baseline not held
Uncollected identity documents	Baseline not held	360,000 uncollected at Home Affairs offices (2026-07-31)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024	Term already expired	No successor strategy held	NO CHANGE

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
IEC digital voter registration (WhatsApp and online portal)	Online portal only	1.7m registration transactions over the final weekend; 291,016 first-time registrations	ADVANCED
MyMzansi single citizen application	Prototype; public access H1 2026	Production-ready pilot; stable platform 2026-09	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
National payment code standard (QR+)	Did not exist	v1.2, eight-bank test cohort	ADVANCED
PayInc and the SARB stake	50% acquired 2025-10	Bank-owned utility; non-bank shareholding ruled out (2026-07-31)	ADVANCED
PayShap	Baseline not held	905m transactions by 2026-05	ADVANCED
Smart IDs issued, calendar year	Baseline not held	4,002,964 in 2025, +17%	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Health Insurance information architecture	In force since 2022-10-21	In force; no implementation measurement held	NO CHANGE
Non-bank payment service provider licensing	Exemption notice in force	No amended Act	NO CHANGE
Digital matric certificate	BASELINE NOT HELD	Piloting (2026-08-03)	Baseline not held
District Health Information System	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hosting out to tender	Baseline not held
Minimum Interoperability Standards and GWEA	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-07-31)	Baseline not held
Online Verification Service	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (undated)	Baseline not held
SAMOS real-time gross settlement	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (undated)	Baseline not held

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Identification and Registration Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Still before Parliament	Baseline not held

The digital identity schedule slipped at every stated milestone. A deadline of April 2025 for cabinet approval of the legal framework was missed; the roadmap milestone of a functional digital identity by the end of the 2025 financial year was missed; the President told Parliament on 12 February 2026 that digital identity and the digital driving licence would [launch during 2026](#); and the department's own plan, tabled six weeks later, [put hosting at 31 March 2027 and operation at 2027/28](#). The draft regulations were nonetheless made and consulted on within the period, and an objection that they may be ultra vires of the Identification Act remains unanswered.

Blocked identity numbers fell by 7,129 in roughly seven months, from 384,189 to [377,060](#), against 702,267 at judgment and a court deadline now running to March 2027. MyMzansi's first public access moved from March 2026 to September 2026. MzansiXchange, launched as a one-year pilot in October 2025, was [nine months in and onboarding further technical capacity](#) at the period's end, with no date set for the rollout decision the pilot was to trigger. Payments moved fastest: PayShap went from 461m cumulative transactions in March 2026 to [905m by May](#), and the central bank became co-owner of the rail in October 2025.

Governance and regulation

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation of Government Roadmap	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2025-03-26)	Baseline not held

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual	Did not exist	Both in draft; manual comments to end-September 2026	ADVANCED
Copyright Amendment Bill	Baseline not held	Constitutional Court ruling 2026-06	ADVANCED
End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations	In consultation	Gazetted 2026-01-23; under review application	ADVANCED, LITIGATED
Information Regulator appropriation	R135.7m (2025/26)	R145.9m (2026/27)	ADVANCED
Operation Vulindlela reporting	80% of initiatives on track (2026-04)	"Uneven and slower than anticipated"	REGRESSED
POPIA enforcement notices	None held	Three notices, May–June 2026	ADVANCED
SADC real-time settlement	Rand only since 2013	Kwaza added 2026-07-27	ADVANCED
Breach notification rate	~284 per month (Apr–Nov 2025)	~263 per month (Q1 2026)	NO CHANGE
Cybercrimes Act	BASELINE NOT HELD	No amendment or count recorded	Baseline not held
National Open Science Policy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (undated)	Baseline not held

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Cost to Communicate Roadmap	Did not exist; no successor instrument after the 2019 Data Services Market Inquiry	Study out to tender; no roadmap published	ADVANCED
Operation Vulindlela Phase II	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2025-03-26)	Baseline not held

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
ICT and Media Regulators Forum	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2024)	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Consumer Protection Act direct-marketing opt-out registry	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-04)	Baseline not held
Mandatory breach reporting e-portal	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2025-04)	Baseline not held
Protection of Personal Information Act and Information Regulator	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2021)	Baseline not held

Enforcement began during the period. The Information Regulator issued its [first 2026 enforcement notice in May](#), a [precedent-setting access-to-information notice against a mining company in June](#), and a third treating a misdirected email as a reportable breach — while the monthly breach-notification rate stayed broadly flat and the statutory maximum penalty remained R10m.

Operation Vulindlela's own reporting changed within the period: a briefing in April 2026 put [80% of digital transformation initiatives on track](#) with 20% complete; the July report replaces that quantified claim with a qualitative statement that progress has been uneven. No later percentage is on record.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-01-30)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National AI policy	Cabinet March 2026, finalise FY2026/27 (as at 2026-02)	No gazetted policy; cabinet Nov 2026 or Jan 2027	REGRESSED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Crypto-asset service provider licensing	300 licences (2025-12-31)	310 licences (2026-03-31)	NO CHANGE
AI-in-finance regulatory framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Planned (2026-07-16)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Automated selection at SARS	<i>Baseline not held</i>	100% of verifications, 88.41% of complex audits	ADVANCED
Expert review panel	Did not exist	14 members appointed 2026-05-14	ADVANCED
Proposed AI regulatory institutions	Seven bodies proposed	Under reconsideration; committee opposed	REGRESSED
SAHPRA AI/ML medical-device requirements	Did not exist	Issued 2025-09-26; product registration not commenced	ADVANCED
Start-up funding, South Africa	Led Africa on equity and deal count, CY2025	Fourth at \$83m, H1 2026	REGRESSED
Prudential Authority AI and cloud supervision standards	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
SARS Modernisation 3.0	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (undated)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Sector-level AI strategies	BASELINE NOT HELD	Planned (undated)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The AI policy changed kind as well as date. A timeline reported in February 2026 had cabinet consideration in March and finalisation within FY2026/27; the draft was published on 2 April, withdrawn later that month, a review panel was appointed on 14 May, and the department stated on 29 July that the replacement [will issue guidelines rather than prescribe rules](#). Automated decision-making expanded through the same period without a governing framework.

Funding reversed within the period. South Africa raised [\\$335.9m across 42 ventures in calendar 2025](#) on a measure its publisher describes as a minimum floor, leading the continent; in the first half of 2026 it [ranked fourth at \\$83m](#) as continental deal count fell 42% year on year.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Bank-account means test across eight grants	Appeal opposed 2026-01-28	Undecided; SCA hearing 2026-08-25	STALLED
MICT SETA	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Referred for assessment 2026-07-21	REGRESSED
Postbank Black Card migration	463,836 active gold cards (2026-04-29)	172,146 replaced by 2026-07-28; 264,263 outstanding	ADVANCED
SASSA biometric verification against Home Affairs	42,000 in first two weeks (2025-09)	997,379 of 19.05m recipients (2026-03)	ADVANCED, PARTIAL
SASSA grant reviews	Biometric enrolment live 2025-09-01	420,000 flagged; ~160,000 incomplete	ADVANCED IN SCOPE, REGRESSED IN ACCESS
SITA performance	<i>Baseline not held</i>	R2.07bn irregular over four years	REGRESSED
Smartphone excise removal	Removed April 2025	1.1m additional entry-level units	ADVANCED
DCDT expenditure	<i>Baseline not held</i>	R3.61bn of R3.74bn spent, FY2025/26	NO CHANGE

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Digital and Future Skills Strategy 2020	2020 strategy in force	Under review; no replacement	STALLED
National Competency Framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Grant verification widened during the period. Biometric enrolment began on 1 September 2025 and had reached [997,379 of 19.05m recipients by March 2026](#), about 5%; 420,000 grants were flagged during 2025/26 and roughly 160,000 beneficiaries did not complete the review, with [child-grant recipients reporting months without payment](#). The litigation that would settle the mechanism was neither implemented nor decided within the twelve months.

At the State Information Technology Agency, a Public Service Commission investigation reported [R2.07bn of irregular expenditure across four audited years](#) and annual performance plan achievement of 42.86% in FY2024/25; the 30-day deadline for a recovery plan expired within the period, and no plan is recorded.

Finance

The base holds no finance rows for South Africa with a position at either end of this window.

The Department of Communications and Digital Technologies spent [R3.61bn of a R3.74bn budget in FY2025/26](#), a shortfall attributed to the stalled broadband programme and funded but vacant posts.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	—	not yet probed
Education management information systems	—	not yet probed
Electronic death registration system	—	not yet probed
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	—	not yet probed
Malabo Convention ratification position	—	not yet probed
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	—	not yet probed
Rules governing state automated decision-making	—	not yet probed
AI incident or assurance register	—	not yet probed
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	—	not yet probed
National digital literacy measurement	—	not yet probed
Municipal ICT expenditure data	—	not yet probed

Seventeen of the fifty-three rows above carry *Baseline not held* at the opening date. Almost all fall in the same five months. The base holds no South African domestic payments source published between August and December 2025, so PayShap volumes, the central bank's October 2025 acquisition of half the payment company, the payment code standard and the social grant card migration are all reconstructed from January 2026 onward. The electronic travel authorisation launched in October 2025 and is first recorded in a February 2026 secondary source. The licensing inquiry that has blocked satellite network licences since August 2025 has no primary document on file at all. Without August to December 2025, this twelve-month comparison is in several places a seven-month one.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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